

The Natural Environment	
Environments	
	Essential content
Apply Water En	- The hydrological cycle: characteristics - Features of a drainage basin, its network. - The hydrograph and river regime (precipitation, temperature, land dams).
On	- Processes: weathering and mass deposition. Factors affecting the velocity, slope, geology). - River channel changes downstream: valleys, interlocking spurs, water flood plains and levees.
Example ility .	- The uses of water: agriculture, leisure. The demand for and supply shortage and water surplus. - Reasons for variations in water (sewage, industrial waste, agricultural of clean water (dams and reservoirs works). - Flooding: causes (intensity of rain, impermeable surfaces, human activities)

Natural Environment Physical environments					
	Essential content	Scale	Required case studies	Recommended fieldwork opportunities (F) and practical skills (P)	
Give a description of the coastal environment.	- The coast as a natural system and its processes: marine (wave action, erosion, deposition, longshore drift); sub-aerial (weathering, mass movement). - Landforms: erosional (headlands and bays; cliffs; wave-cut platforms; caves; arches, stacks and stumps); depositional (beaches, spits, bars). - The impact of geology, vegetation, people and sea-level changes on coasts.	Regional and small (local)	1 Case study of two geologically contrasting coastlines.	Annotated sketches based on photographs (F/P). Investigating beach profiles and sediment characteristics (F).	
Discuss the impact of coastal ecosystems on the environment.	- Coastal ecosystems (coral reefs, mangroves, sand dunes, salt marshes) and their biodiversity. - Physical factors affecting the distributions of coastal ecosystems. - Coastal ecosystems are of value to people, but are threatened by tourism and other developments (industrialisation, agricultural practices, deforestation).	Global and small (local)	2 Case study of one coastal ecosystem.	Investigation of coastal ecosystems based on maps, photographs and other sources of information (P).	
Discuss the impact of coastal management on the environment.	- Conflicts between different users of the coast and between development and conservation. - Coastal retreat and its management. Coastal protection: soft and hard engineering; conflicting views.	National, regional and small (local)	3 Case study of a retreating coastline – causes, impacts and management.	Investigating the conflicts between development and conservation on a stretch of coastline (F).	

Natural Environment				
Geographical context				
Essential content				
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Core concepts.	Global and regional		Mapping the global distribution of recent hazards (P). Investigating weather conditions (F).	
Impact	Regional and small (local)	1 A case study of the comparative impacts of a tropical storm in an LIC and an HIC.	Research into a recent hazard event (P).	
Hazards on after	National	2 Case study of the management of a tectonic event. 3 Case study of the management of either river flooding or coastal flooding.	Investigating people's views on the management of a hazard event (F).	

	Scale	Required case studies	Recommended fieldwork opportunities (F) and practical skills (P)
tor: primary, nic sectors changes with d within countries. acteristics. and growth of tertiary aw technology, icy). of manufacturing (TNCs, government policy).	Global, national and regional Regional Global	1 A comparative study of sectoral shifts in one HIC and one LIC. 2 Case study of the factors affecting the development and location of one high-tech industry. 3 Case study of a de-industrialised area – causes, consequences and subsequent 'development'.	Graphical representation of employment sector data (P). Investigating the location factors of factories or services (F).
nergy gap. and the need for energy eg wind, tidal and energy (eg fossil fuels	Global, national and small (local)		Research into energy sources of home country (P). Investigating people's conflicting views on the use and impacts of renewable and non-renewable energy (F).